is perhaps the best. You must know that near Tehran there is a very high mountain the summit of which is clad with eternal snow. Meerza Aga Khan the minister of war is a very clever man and the Hadji knowing him to be so, loses no opportunity of giving him a rap on the knuckles so as to keep him down, and prevent his interfering with him; for in no country in the world has sarcasm, wit and ridicule, such power as it has in Persia. Some time ago when Meerza Aga Khan presented himself early in the morning at the Hadji's levée, the Hadji turned towards him suddenly and said "Meerza Aga Khan are you aware that the devil attended by a large retinue sits every morning before sunrise on the peak of Demawund?" (the mountain before mentioned). "No," said the man expecting something disagreeable. "Yes he does," said the Hadji, "and as the sun begins to rise he sends some of his people into the town to bring him intelligence of what Meerza Aga Khan is about, and when they return and report to their master that Meerza Aga Khan is up, and has put on his shoes, and is on his way to the court he says come along boys, we need not trouble ourselves about Tehran any more to day, Meerza Aga Khan will make quite mischief enough there without our assistance!" Not bad was it?

Are we to have war about "the Creole?"[61] bravo the blackees, say I. I think you will own that your friends have got hold of the wrong pig by the ear in this question. I have only seen the London papers up to the 15th April. Please when you write let me know something about the Canadian frontier that is if you hear any thing about the "sympathizers."[62]

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tabreez, August 1, 1843*

We do not yet know whether we are to have war or peace with Turkey. About a month ago the Shah wrote to his brother the governor here, ordering him to hold himself in such a state of readiness, that if in the morning he received orders from him, to take the field with twenty thousand men he could march out of Tabreez before the evening: this looked like war; and the Shah himself had moved out of Tehran and ordered warlike preparations to be made all along the frontier. But since then I believe the mediators England and Russia have obliged

[61] On Oct. 27, 1841, the *Creole*, a brig from Richmond, Virginia, sailed from Hampton Roads for New Orleans with a cargo of slaves and tobacco. During the voyage some of the slaves revolted and killed the slave dealer, then forced the crew to put in at Nassau. There the British authorities freed the slaves, after holding nineteen on charges of murder and mutiny. Southern politicians waxed furious over the incident but saner counsels prevailed and eventually the case was arbitrated and the United States awarded monetary damages for interference with the cargo of the ship.

[62] These were American sympathizers of a Canadian separatist movement, cf. footnote 53, on the McLeod affair.

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